Occupational Employment Statistics

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Occupational Employment and Wages, May 2018

29-1126 Respiratory Therapists

Assess, treat, and care for patients with breathing disorders. Assume primary responsibility for all respiratory care modalities, including the supervision of respiratory therapy technicians. Initiate and conduct therapeutic procedures; maintain patient records; and select, assemble, check, and operate equipment.

National estimates for this occupation
Industry profile for this occupation
Geographic profile for this occupation

National estimates for this occupation: Top

Employment estimate and mean wage estimates for this occupation:

Employment (1)	Employment RSE (3)	Mean hourly wage	Mean annual wage (2)	Wage RSE (3)
129,600	1.1 %	$30.05	$62,500	0.3 %

Percentile wage estimates for this occupation:

Percentile	10%	25%	50% (Median)	75%	90%
Hourly Wage	$21.03	$24.73	$28.98	$34.98	$40.15
Annual Wage (2)	$43,750	$51,430	$60,280	$72,760	$83,520

Industry profile for this occupation: Top

Industries with the highest published employment and wages for this occupation are provided. For a list of all industries with employment in this occupation, see the Create Customized Tables function.

Industries with the highest levels of employment in this occupation:

Industry	Employment (1)	Percent of industry employment	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
General Medical and Surgical Hospitals	98,960	1.78	$30.08	$62,570
Specialty (except Psychiatric and Substance Abuse) Hospitals	7,480	2.86	$30.95	$64,380
Nursing Care Facilities (Skilled Nursing Facilities)	6,070	0.38	$30.09	$62,590
Offices of Physicians	2,890	0.11	$29.35	$61,050
Rental and Leasing Services (5322, 5323, and 5324 only)	2,620	0.77	$26.03	$54,130

Industries with the highest concentration of employment in this occupation:

Industry	Employment (1)	Percent of industry employment	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Specialty (except Psychiatric and Substance Abuse) Hospitals	7,480	2.86	$30.95	$64,380
General Medical and Surgical Hospitals	98,960	1.78	$30.08	$62,570
Rental and Leasing Services (5322, 5323, and 5324 only)	2,620	0.77	$26.03	$54,130
Nursing Care Facilities (Skilled Nursing Facilities)	6,070	0.38	$30.09	$62,590
Professional and Commercial Equipment and Supplies Merchant Wholesalers	1,190	0.18	$28.04	$58,330

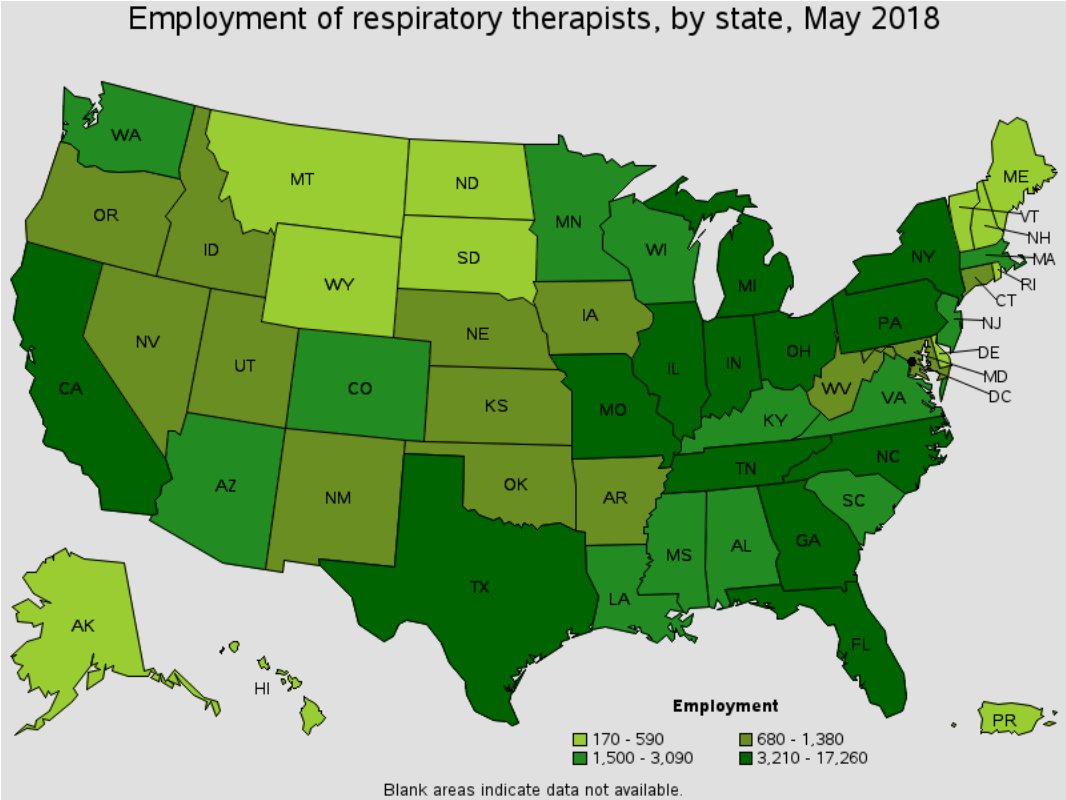
Top paying industries for this occupation:

Industry	Employment (1)	Percent of industry employment	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Local Government, excluding schools and hospitals (OES Designation)	270	(7)	$37.20	$77,380
Outpatient Care Centers	1,260	0.14	$36.54	$76,000
Colleges, Universities, and Professional Schools	440	0.01	$36.24	$75,370
Specialty (except Psychiatric and Substance Abuse)	7,480	2.86	$30.95	$64,380

Hospitals				
Employment Services	(8)	(8)	$30.50	$63,450

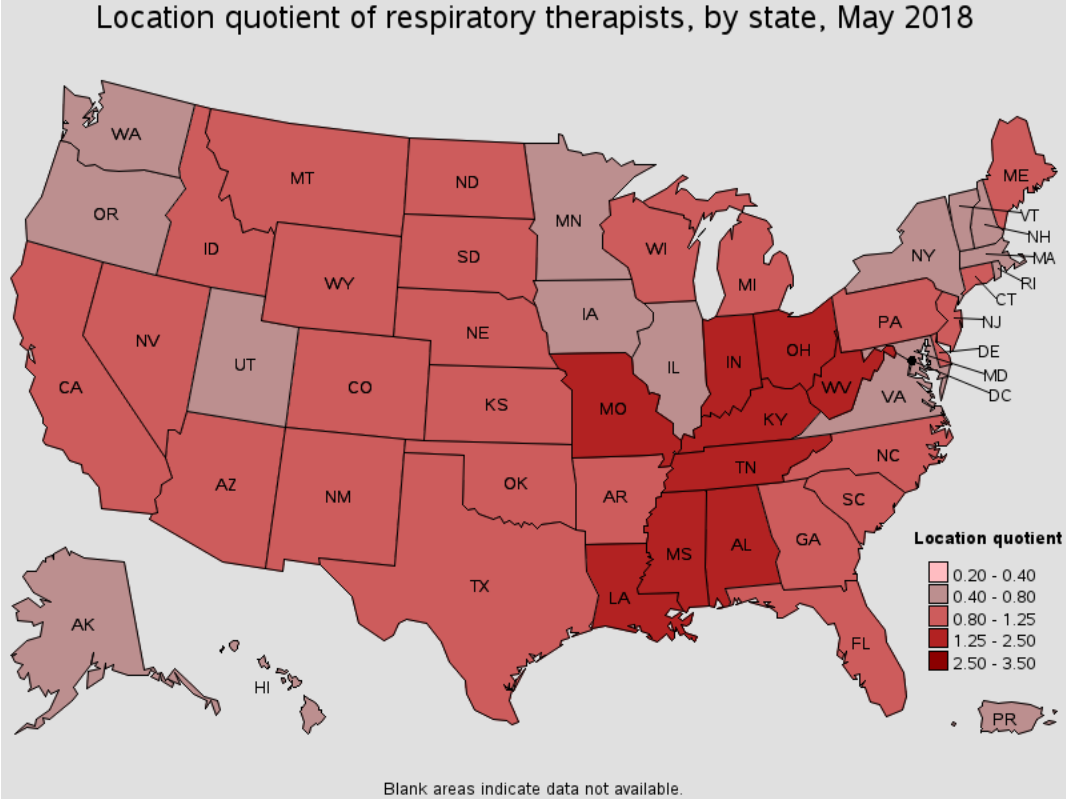
Geographic profile for this occupation: Top

States and areas with the highest published employment, location quotients, and wages for this occupation are provided. For a list of all areas with employment in this occupation, see the Create Customized Tables function.



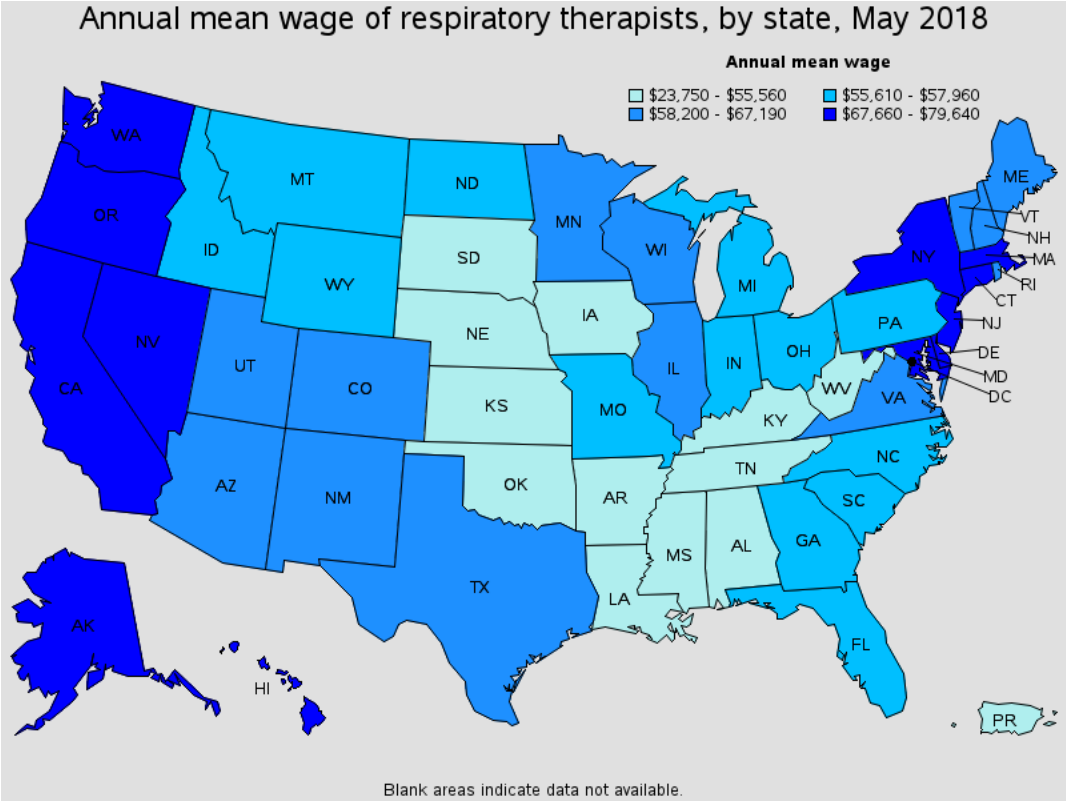
States with the highest employment level in this occupation:

State	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
California	17,260	1.01	1.13	$38.29	$79,640
Texas	11,250	0.93	1.04	$28.81	$59,930
Florida	8,200	0.95	1.06	$27.86	$57,960
Ohio	6,200	1.14	1.28	$27.32	$56,830
Pennsylvania	5,810	0.99	1.11	$27.39	$56,970



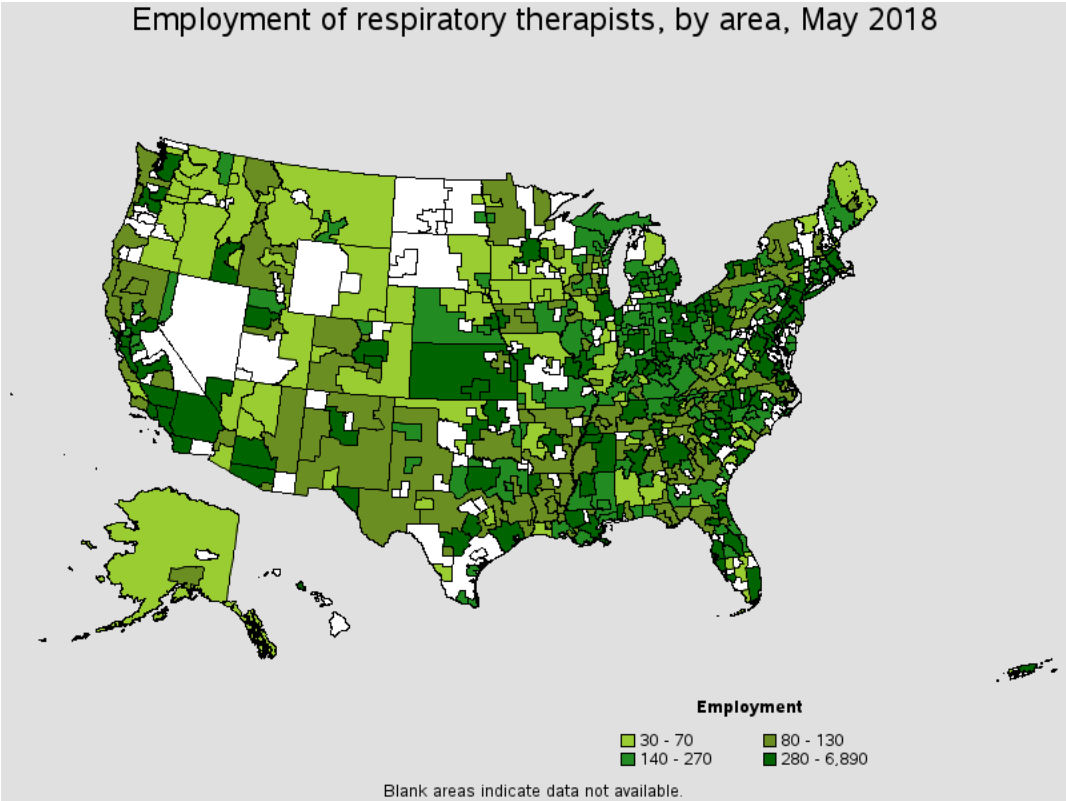
States with the highest concentration of jobs and location quotients in this occupation:

State	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
West Virginia	1,020	1.46	1.63	$24.24	$50,420
Mississippi	1,500	1.34	1.49	$23.66	$49,220
Indiana	4,010	1.32	1.47	$26.74	$55,610
Kentucky	2,480	1.31	1.46	$23.99	$49,890
Alabama	2,450	1.26	1.41	$24.41	$50,770



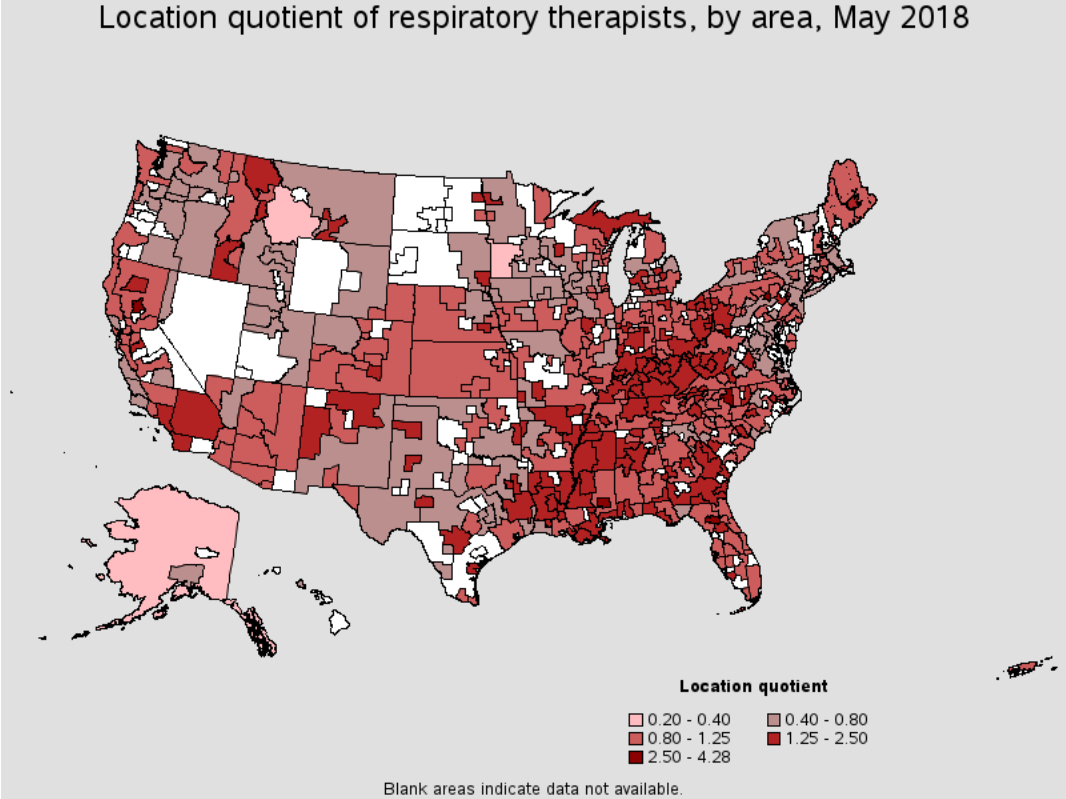
Top paying States for this occupation:

State	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
California	17,260	1.01	1.13	$38.29	$79,640
District of Columbia	290	0.41	0.46	$37.76	$78,540
Alaska	170	0.54	0.60	$36.83	$76,610
New York	5,740	0.61	0.68	$36.01	$74,890
Massachusetts	2,370	0.66	0.74	$35.42	$73,660



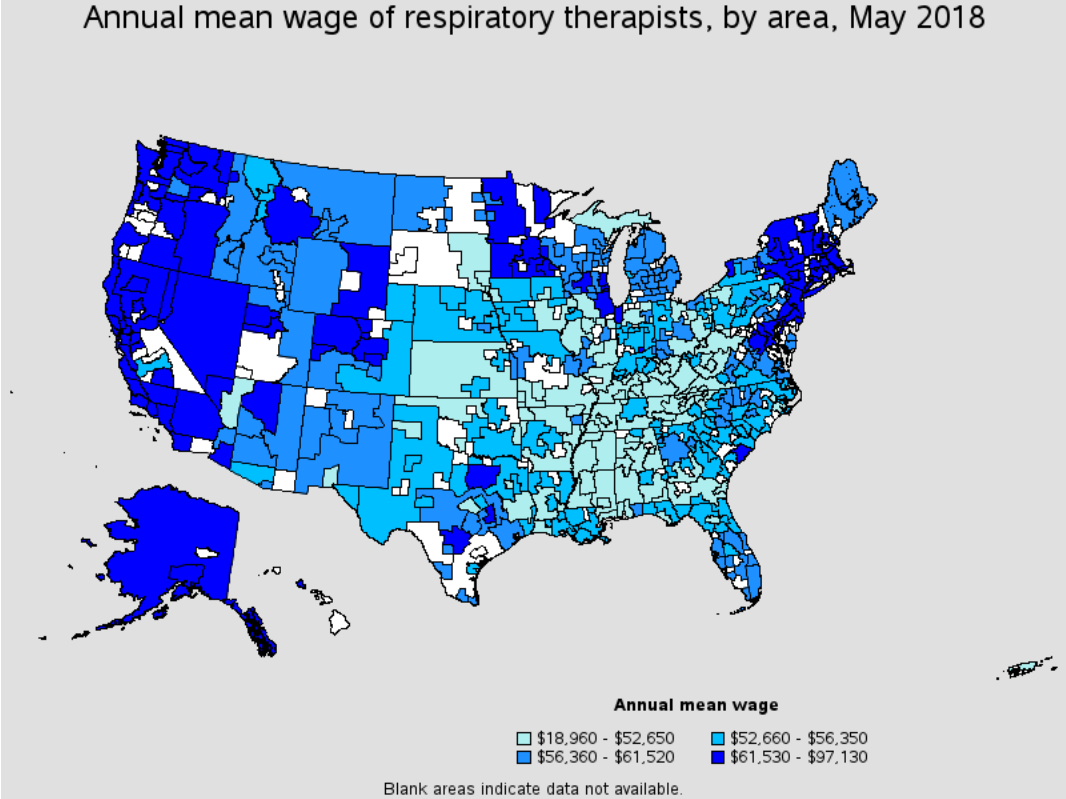
Metropolitan areas with the highest employment level in this occupation:

Metropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Los Angeles-Long Beach-Anaheim, CA	6,890	1.13	1.26	$36.23	$75,360
New York-Newark-Jersey City, NY-NJ-PA	5,870	0.62	0.69	$37.92	$78,870
Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX	3,320	0.93	1.04	$29.99	$62,370
Chicago-Naperville-Elgin, IL-IN-WI	3,320	0.71	0.80	$30.41	$63,250
Philadelphia-Camden-Wilmington, PA-NJ-DE-MD	2,840	1.00	1.11	$29.92	$62,220
Miami-Fort Lauderdale-West Palm Beach, FL	2,640	1.02	1.14	$27.95	$58,150
Houston-The Woodlands-Sugar Land, TX	2,530	0.85	0.95	$29.24	$60,810
Atlanta-Sandy Springs-Roswell, GA	2,300	0.86	0.96	$29.19	$60,720
Detroit-Warren-Dearborn, MI	2,070	1.05	1.17	$27.35	$56,890
San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward, CA	2,020	0.83	0.93	$44.40	$92,350



Metropolitan areas with the highest concentration of jobs and location quotients in this occupation:

Metropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Bloomsburg-Berwick, PA	160	3.83	4.28	$27.22	$56,610
Morgantown, WV	190	2.86	3.20	$24.84	$51,660
Winston-Salem, NC	710	2.68	2.99	$28.01	$58,260
Gainesville, FL	330	2.49	2.78	$24.79	$51,560
Muncie, IN	110	2.46	2.75	$26.60	$55,320
Hattiesburg, MS	150	2.40	2.69	$23.44	$48,760
Chico, CA	190	2.33	2.60	$36.24	$75,370
Johnson City, TN	170	2.22	2.48	$21.96	$45,670
Greenville, NC	160	2.10	2.34	$24.56	$51,080
Anniston-Oxford-Jacksonville, AL	90	2.09	2.33	$25.29	$52,610



Top paying metropolitan areas for this occupation:

Metropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Salinas, CA	100	0.56	0.62	$46.70	$97,130
Sacramento--Roseville--Arden-Arcade, CA	960	0.97	1.08	$44.83	$93,240
San Francisco-Oakland-Hayward, CA	2,020	0.83	0.93	$44.40	$92,350
Santa Maria-Santa Barbara, CA	120	0.63	0.70	$44.04	$91,610
Redding, CA	90	1.37	1.53	$43.37	$90,210
San Jose-Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, CA	920	0.82	0.92	$41.50	$86,330
Stockton-Lodi, CA	200	0.81	0.90	$41.06	$85,400
Modesto, CA	220	1.21	1.35	$40.52	$84,270
Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura, CA	280	0.89	0.99	$39.49	$82,140
Napa, CA	(8)	(8)	(8)	$39.42	$81,990

Nonmetropolitan areas with the highest employment in this occupation:

Nonmetropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
North Northeastern Ohio non-metropolitan area (non-contiguous)	350	1.05	1.18	$24.83	$51,640
Kansas nonmetropolitan area	350	0.89	0.99	$25.06	$52,130
Northeast Mississippi nonmetropolitan area	290	1.25	1.40	$23.13	$48,110
Piedmont North Carolina nonmetropolitan area	270	1.06	1.18	$25.77	$53,600
West Northwestern Ohio nonmetropolitan area	270	1.05	1.17	$25.45	$52,950

Nonmetropolitan areas with the highest concentration of jobs and location quotients in this occupation:

Nonmetropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Southwest Mississippi nonmetropolitan area	150	2.09	2.34	$23.41	$48,690
Southwest Louisiana nonmetropolitan area	120	1.74	1.94	$26.16	$54,420

Central Louisiana nonmetropolitan area	130	1.62	1.81	$25.17	$52,360
East Kentucky nonmetropolitan area	160	1.62	1.81	$19.63	$40,820
West Kentucky nonmetropolitan area	220	1.48	1.65	$23.65	$49,180

Top paying nonmetropolitan areas for this occupation:

Nonmetropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Alaska nonmetropolitan area	30	0.30	0.33	$40.14	$83,500
North Valley-Northern Mountains Region of California nonmetropolitan area	90	0.92	1.03	$39.89	$82,970
North Coast Region of California nonmetropolitan area	110	1.02	1.13	$37.51	$78,010
Central New Hampshire nonmetropolitan area	(8)	(8)	(8)	$32.36	$67,310
Nevada nonmetropolitan area	(8)	(8)	(8)	$32.31	$67,200

About May 2018 National, State, Metropolitan, and Nonmetropolitan Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

These estimates are calculated with data collected from employers in all industry sectors, all metropolitan and nonmetropolitan areas, and all states and the District of Columbia. The top employment and wage figures are provided above. The complete list is available in the downloadable XLS files.

The percentile wage estimate is the value of a wage below which a certain percent of workers fall. The median wage is the 50th percentile wage estimate--50 percent of workers earn less than the median and 50 percent of workers earn more than the median. More about percentile wages.

(1) Estimates for detailed occupations do not sum to the totals because the totals include occupations not shown separately. Estimates do not include self-employed workers.

(2) Annual wages have been calculated by multiplying the hourly mean wage by a "year-round, full-time" hours figure of 2,080 hours; for those occupations where there is not an hourly wage published, the annual wage has been directly calculated from the reported survey data.

(3) The relative standard error (RSE) is a measure of the reliability of a survey statistic. The smaller the relative standard error, the more precise the estimate.

(7) The value is less than .005 percent of industry employment.

(8) Estimate not released.

(9) The location quotient is the ratio of the area concentration of occupational employment to the national average concentration. A location quotient greater than one indicates the occupation has a higher share of employment than average, and a location quotient less than one indicates the occupation is less prevalent in the area than average.

Other OES estimates and related information:

May 2018 National Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2018 State Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2018 Metropolitan and Nonmetropolitan Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2018 National Industry-Specific Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2018 Occupation Profiles

Technical Notes

Last Modified Date: March 29, 2019

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